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hypothesis

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Entertainment PC

■ What is it?

Intel wants to form a new home computing platform, powered by the 90 nm Pentium 4 Prescott CPU and supported by the upcoming Grantsdale chipset.

■ How does it work?

Grantsdale features dual-channel 400/533 MHz DDR 2 SDRAM support, PCI Express, the next generation of Intel's Extreme Graphics and Azalia—an audio sub-system with Dolby 7.1 surround sound. The graphics supports dual independent-display support, and the DirectX 9 API. Grantsdale will also feature a software-based Wi-Fi access point.

■ What does it do?

A platform definition that lays down what an Entertainment PC (EPC) should contain: primarily, a Prescott and Grantsdale, all inside a consumer electronics-style casing. The EPC is designed to work alongside consumer electronics devices such as big-screen TVs and hi-fi speaker rigs, rather than sit next to a monitor.

snapshot

**119 million
LCDs and 30
million CRTs
will be shipped
by 2007**

Source: IDC/CNET News.com

Hey! You can't do that...

Community Web site, Neowin.net, first reported a source-code leak of parts of Microsoft's operating systems. The code was related to NT4 and Windows 2000; Windows XP inherits some of it. Another community Web site, Betanews, stated that the leak was traced back to Microsoft

partner, Mainsoft, the company has access to Windows source-code, enabling the industry's highest level of Windows compliancy on Unix.

Security concerns



Mahesh Benkar

turned real when a few days later, a hacker released an exploit that injects malicious code to trigger an integer overflow and execute arbitrary code when a special bitmap is loaded by IE 5.

Don't forget your desktop, dear!

You may soon be able to fold your desktop PC and carry it between home and office, underarm. At the time of writing this, Intel plans to unveil such a prototype.

The prototype has a 17-inch LCD with a handle on top to afford portability. It will be one of three models to be unveiled alongside two business notebooks—the trio are collectively termed Florence. The system will feature a keyboard that slides out of the back of the display. Intel envisions the unit to be used as a portable



television: Its bevelled LCD hides a digital camera, speakers and a microphone.

It allows for a telephone handset for placing voice over Internet Protocol phone calls, and a remote for multimedia functions. Security is provided by a fingerprint sensor and a smart card reader.

Mike Trainor, chief technology evangelist of the Intel mobile platform indicated that the units will be powered by Sonoma, which comprises Pentium M processor, a set of support chips and a wireless module.

400 MHz dragons

Chinese newspaper, The People's Daily, claimed that processors designed by Chinese engineers will be marketed worldwide, following a deal with Wyse Technology.

The Arca 2 chips in question have clock speeds of 400 MHz and a power consumption of 0.4 W. Wyse will initially use them in its network computers, powered by the Blazers OS.

MCSE at eight!

Sikkim resident, Mridul Seth, is most likely the youngest to earn the Microsoft Certified Software Engineer (MCSE) certificate. A mere lad of eight, he has accomplished what people thrice his age struggle at. He is believed to be the youngest MCSE, as on February 12 2004, he passed the Installing, Configuring and Administering Microsoft 2000 Professional Examinations held in Bangalore.

Mridul did not learn to speak until about 4 years ago. He was born without an external ear and his father, M.K. Seth, added that he was often sick when younger. At four, he learned to count from 1 to 100 within 24 hours, after which Mr Seth taught him higher mathematics.

Felicited by Prime Minister A.B. Vajpayee, the family has now written to the Guinness Book of Records to acknowledge Mridul as the youngest person to earn the Microsoft degree.

■ In February, Yahoo! dropped Google, and implemented Yahoo! Slurp, its own Web crawler ■ Cisco offers desktop video-conferencing via VoIP